

MEASURE	2021	2025	CHANGE
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STAY INTENTIONS

Overall	73%*	75.8% ²⁰²⁴	+2.8 pp	▲
By region				
International students from Africa	72.5%*	86.5% ²⁰²⁴	+14.0 pp	▲
International students from the Americas	60.1%*	69.3% ²⁰²⁴	+9.2 pp	▲
International students from Asia	79%*	80% ²⁰²⁴	+1.0 pp	▲
International students from Europe	67.4%*	66.4% ²⁰²⁴	-1.0 pp	▼
International students from the Middle East	58%*	55.3% ²⁰²⁴	-2.7 pp	▼

By field

International students studying computing	87.4%	89.8% ²⁰²⁴	+2.4 pp	▲
International students studying engineering	85.2%	89.5% ²⁰²⁴	+4.3 pp	▲
International students studying mathematics	74.8%	81.7% ²⁰²⁴	+6.9 pp	▲
International students studying the physical sciences	81.9%	87.2% ²⁰²⁴	+5.4 pp	▲

REALIZED RETENTION

Five-year stay rate	70.8%*	73.4% ²⁰²³	+2.6 pp	▲
Ten-year stay rate	64.7%*	67.8% ²⁰²³	+3.1 pp	▲

CAREER PATHS AFTER THE PHD

US citizens: academe	39.9%*	42.5% ²⁰²⁴	+2.6 pp	▲
US citizens: industry or business	33.8%*	32.2% ²⁰²⁴	-1.6 pp	▼
Temporary visa holders: academe	24.8%*	32.2% ²⁰²⁴	+7.4 pp	▲
Temporary visa holders: industry or business	69.4%*	60.9% ²⁰²⁴	-8.5 pp	▼

WORK-VISA BRIDGE

STEM OPT applications received	5,940*	22,300	3.75×	▲
STEM OPT applications approved	5,990*	18,700	3.13×	▲
H-1B approvals: tech occupations	106,000*	85,100	-19.8%	▼

IMMIGRATION PATHWAYS AND BOTTLENECKS

EB-2 green-card wait for Indian nationals	10y 6m*	12y 5m	+2y	▲
EB-2 green-card wait for Chinese nationals	3y 10m*	4y 8m	+9 mo	▲
EB-2 green-card wait for all other nationalities	2y 10m*	4y 6m	+1y 8m	▲

ESTIMATED LOSS FROM DEPARTING STEM TALENT

FIELD	NO. DEPARTING	SHARE DEPARTING	MONEY LOST
Engineering	4,350	29%	\$1.52B
Life, health, and agricultural sciences	3,140	30%	\$1.15B
Physical sciences	2,240	35%	\$0.712B
Computer and math sciences	1,280	24%	\$0.449B

* Data are available further back than 2021 for marked series.

Note: Historical comparisons use 2021 and 2025 observations. Superscript years mark rows with an earlier latest endpoint than 2025. Estimated money lost = departures × field-specific time to degree × \$53,000 annual NSF GRFP support.

Source: Derived from Figures 6.01-6.07; Tables 6.01-6.04.